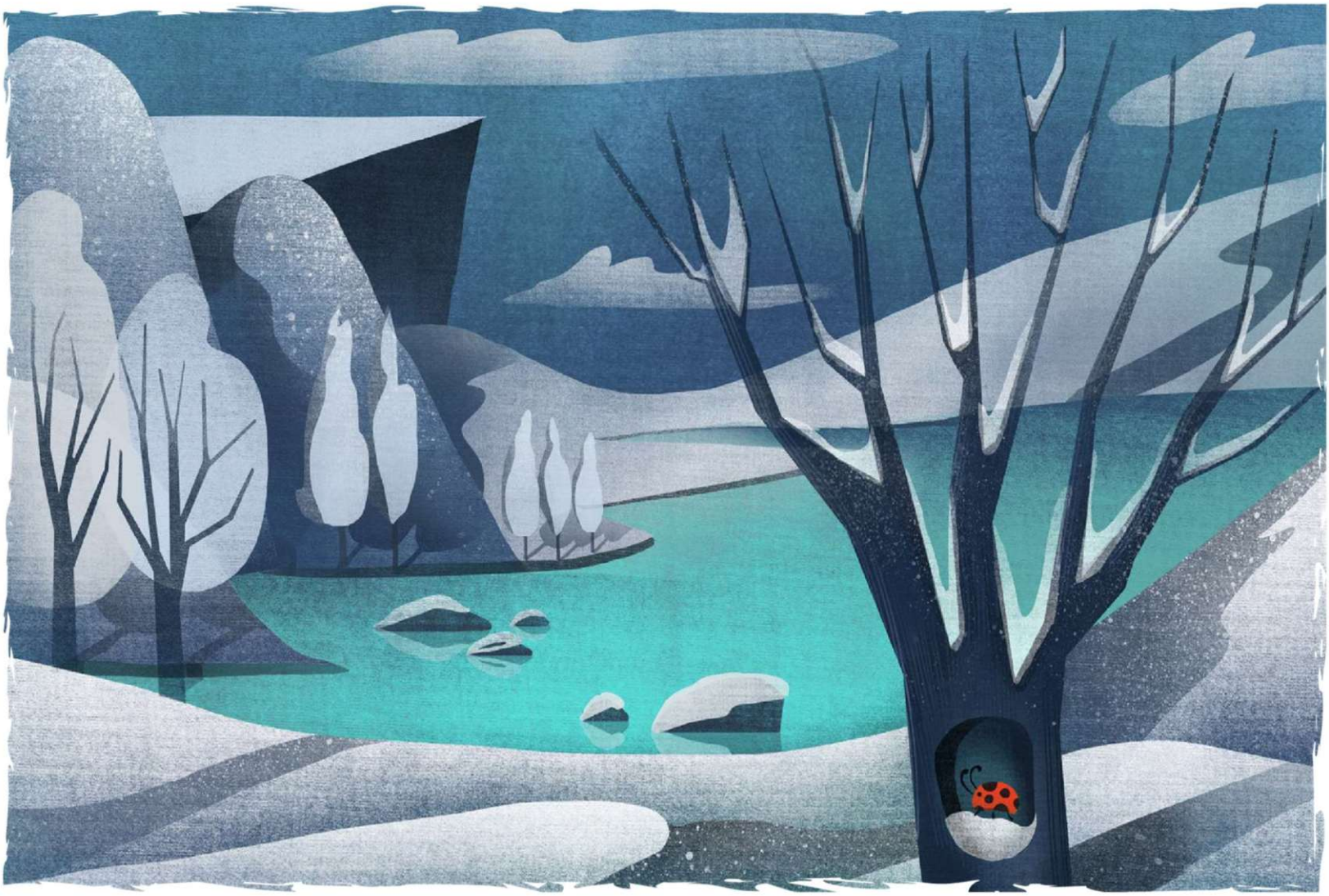
Managing People and Organization

End Term Assignment



SECTION-A: TEAM ZENITH CASE ANALYSIS

QUES 1(A): DOMINANT BIG FIVE PERSONALITY TRAITS

The Big Five personality model assesses individuals based on five core dimensions: Conscientiousness, Emotional Stability, Extraversion, Openness to Experience, and Agreeableness (Robbins & Judge, 2019). Based on the behaviors exhibited in the case, the dominant traits for the team members are:

1. NEHA – EXTRAVERSION:

Neha exhibits high extraversion, characterized by sociability, assertiveness, and energy. She is the first to break the silence, takes the lead immediately ("I'll play anchor"), and dominates the social atmosphere ("enthusiastic laughter"). Her need to be the center of attention is evident when she overrides quieter voices to maintain the high energy she prefers.

2. AAKASH – INTROVERSION (LOW EXTRAVERSION):

Aakash displays clear signs of introversion (or low extraversion). He is described as uncomfortable with the social aspects of the group ("shifted uncomfortably," "avoided eye contact"). He prefers solitary work environments and finds the team's high-energy dynamic draining ("This team's too loud for me"), leading him to withdraw from meetings entirely.

3. FATIMA – OPENNESS TO EXPERIENCE:

Fatima demonstrates high openness to experience. Individuals with this trait are creative, curious, and open to novelty. She explicitly states she is "obsessed with pushing boundaries" and rejects rigid rules ("we don't need a rulebook"). Her approach is experimental and visionary, prioritizing innovation over established procedures.

4. SAHIL – CONSCIENTIOUSNESS:

Sahil represents high conscientiousness. This trait is associated with being responsible, organized, and dependable. He immediately focuses on structure, scope, and planning ("Let's slow down and define scope first"). He is risk-averse regarding the undefined nature of the project and judges Fatima's ideas based on their practicality and adherence to structure.

5. RAVI – AGREEABLENESS:

Ravi displays high agreeableness. He is cooperative and seeks harmony within the group. When conflict arises between the "chaos" of Fatima and the "control" of Sahil, Ravi attempts to mediate ("Maybe we can find a balance?"). Even when insulted, he initially smiles faintly to avoid confrontation, prioritizing group cohesion over his own ego until the environment becomes too toxic.

QUES 1(B): PERCEPTUAL ERRORS

Perception is the process by which individuals organize and interpret sensory impressions to give meaning to their environment, but this process is often distorted by shortcuts (McShane & Von Glinow, 2018). Two specific errors present in this case are:

1. STEREOTYPING

- **Explanation:** Stereotyping occurs when an individual judges someone based on their perception of the group to which that person belongs, rather than their individual characteristics.

- **Occurrence in Case:** Neha dismisses Ravi's valid suggestion about testing the chatbot by saying, "Oh come on, Ravi — HR always wants more forms." She reduced Ravi's

professional input to a generalized, negative stereotype about Human Resources being bureaucratic.

- **Impact:** This caused Ravi to withdraw from the team ("didn't speak again that day"). By ignoring the "HR perspective" due to a stereotype, the team missed a critical risk-management step, contributing to the missed internal deadline and team fragmentation.

2. Selective Perception

- **Explanation:** This is the tendency to selectively interpret what one sees on the basis of one's interests, background, experience, and attitudes.

- **Occurrence in Case:** Sahil admits, "I've been tuning out some ideas. I thought they were impractical." Because Sahil values structure (Conscientiousness), he filtered out Fatima's creative inputs as "style over substance" without genuinely evaluating them.

- **Impact:** This created a communication breakdown. Sahil failed to leverage potentially innovative solutions because he only "heard" what fit his own structured mental model. This alienated Fatima, who felt untrusted, and prevented the integration of creative design with backend stability during the Storming phase.

Ques 1(c): Tuckman's Stages of Group Development

Tuckman's model suggests that groups move through predictable stages: Forming, Storming, Norming, Performing, and Adjourning (Robbins & Judge, 2019). Team Zenith's progression is as follows:

1. FORMING

- **Description:** This stage is characterized by uncertainty and politeness as members "test the waters."
- **Team Zenith:** This occurred during the first meeting in the glass-walled room. There was "awkward silence," and members gave tentative introductions. Aakash was adjusting his pen nervously, and Neha tried to break the ice. Members were guarding their true feelings to be accepted.

2. STORMING

- **Description:** Intragroup conflict arises as members resist constraints and vie for control.
- **Team Zenith:** This phase occupied the first two weeks. "Small cracks" appeared. Subgroups formed (Neha and Fatima vs. Sahil and Aakash). There was active conflict: Aakash stopped attending meetings, Sahil gave flat responses ("Noted"), and Neha openly mocked Ravi. The team was dysfunctional, with low trust and high tension.

3. NORMING

- **Description:** Close relationships develop, and the group demonstrates cohesiveness and a common set of expectations.
- **Team Zenith:** This occurred during and immediately after the manager's feedback session. The team had an honest conversation ("That one's on me"). They established new norms: "Meetings were time-boxed," "rotating facilitation," and creating space for quieter voices. They accepted each other's differences and defined roles clearly.

4. PERFORMING

- **Description:** The structure is fully functional, and group energy has moved from getting to know each other to performing the task at hand.
- **Team Zenith:** In the final six weeks, the team utilized their diverse skills effectively. Aakash automated Ravi's tracker; Fatima paired ideas with Sahil's timelines. They became a cohesive unit, launching the prototype early and working synergistically.

SECTION-B: DARSHANA TEXTILES CASE ANALYSIS

QUES 2(A): WORKFORCE PLANNING PROCESS

Workforce planning is the process of deciding what positions the firm will have to fill and how to fill them (Dessler, 2020). Given the crisis at Darshana Textiles, the company must move from reactive panic to strategic planning using the following steps:

FORECAST DEMAND (DEMAND ANALYSIS):

The management must analyze the viral trend data rather than guessing "15 or 40" people. They need to determine if this spike is temporary (fad) or sustainable. They should calculate the specific labor hours required to clear the backlog of orders and handle ongoing customer service inquiries.

ANALYZE SUPPLY (SUPPLY ANALYSIS):

Rachita must audit the current workforce. This involves identifying existing skills (e.g., the showroom assistant who wants to move to backend) and checking the availability of part-timers who want longer hours.

GAP ANALYSIS:

Compare the forecasted demand against the current supply. This will provide the exact number of staff needed for warehousing vs. customer service, rather than the manager's guess.

ACTION PLANNING:

Develop a plan to bridge the gap. This includes deciding on the mix of temporary staff (to handle the immediate viral spike) versus permanent hires (for long-term growth) and initiating recruitment.

IMPORTANCE IN THIS SCENARIO:

Workforce planning is critical here because "instinctive hiring" leads to inefficiency. Without planning, Darshana Textiles risks over-hiring (creating financial burden if demand drops) or mis-hiring (getting people with the wrong skills). It allows them to leverage internal talent first (increasing morale) and ensures that the delivery crisis is solved systematically without burning out existing staff.

QUES 2(B): SOURCES OF RECRUITMENT

1. INTERNAL SOURCES

- **Job Posting / Internal Bidding:**
    - ***Application**:* Rachita can advertise the open backend and coordination roles on the company intranet or notice boards.
    - ***Advantage:*** Capitalizes on existing knowledge. The showroom assistant already knows the products, reducing training time. It also boosts morale by offering career shifts.

- ***Limitation:*** It may create a vacancy in the previous department (the showroom) that subsequently needs filling (Armstrong & Taylor, 2020).

- **Employee Referrals:**
  - ***Application:*** Ask current satisfied employees (warehouse or sales staff) to refer friends or family for the urgent roles.
  - ***Advantage:*** Generally faster and cheaper than external advertising; referred candidates often have a more realistic job preview.
  - ***Limitation:*** Can lead to nepotism or a lack of diversity in the workforce if the current staff demographics are homogenous.

2. EXTERNAL SOURCES

- **Employment Agencies / Staffing Firms:**
  - ***Application:*** Engage a temp agency to supply warehouse staff and packers immediately.
  - ***Advantage:*** This is the fastest way to get a high volume of staff ("40 people") for manual roles without the HR team having to screen every resume personally.
  - ***Limitation:*** High cost due to agency fees, and temporary agency staff may have less commitment to the brand quality than direct hires.

- **Social Media Recruiting:**
  - ***Application:*** Since the brand went viral on social media, they should post "We are Hiring" content on the very platforms where they are trending.

- ***Advantage:*** Targets candidates who are already fans of the brand and understand the aesthetic/culture. It costs very little.
- ***Limitation:*** Can result in a flood of unqualified applicants, overwhelming the already busy HR team with screening duties.

QUES 2(C): SELECTION TESTS

To ensure efficiency and quality during this rapid hiring phase, the following tests are recommended:

1. WORK SAMPLE / SIMULATION TEST (FOR CUSTOMER SERVICE)

- **Recommendation:** A short simulation where the candidate must draft a reply to an angry customer email or handle a mock complaint call regarding a delayed delivery.
- **Justification:** Since the company is currently facing a backlog of unanswered emails and complaints, this test has high *content validity*. It directly predicts job performance by testing the candidate's empathy, writing speed, and ability to de-escalate situations under pressure (Dessler, 2020).

2. PHYSICAL ABILITY / PSYCHOMOTOR TEST (FOR WAREHOUSE STAFF)

- **Recommendation:** A test measuring manual dexterity, lifting capability, and packaging speed.
- **Justification:** The role involves physical labor (warehousing, packaging). A resume cannot prove if a candidate can stand for 8 hours or pack fragile cushion covers quickly without damaging them. This ensures the new hires have the physical stamina and coordination required to clear the backlog immediately.

References

Armstrong, M., & Taylor, S. (2020). *Armstrong's handbook of human resource management practice* (15th ed.). Kogan Page.

Dessler, G. (2020). *Human resource management* (16th ed.). Pearson.

McShane, S. L., & Von Glinow, M. A. (2018). *Organizational behavior: Emerging knowledge. Global reality* (8th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.

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